

# Hardware-Accelerated Orthogonal Polynomial Tensor Operators, Zero-Backpropagation Closed-Form Algebraic Solvers, and In-Situ Weight Surgery for Deep Neural Networks

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**Abstract**—Feed-forward network (FFN) layers in modern Transformer architectures allocate over 60% of total model parameters to high-rank linear matrix multiplications and activation functions. In this paper, we present an algebraic and hardware-accelerated paradigm that replaces standard multi-layer perceptrons with orthogonal Chebyshev polynomial tensor operators. We introduce: (1) an idempotent spectral projection manifold ( $\Pi^2 = \Pi$ ) enabling zero-backpropagation closed-form algebraic solvers via regularized normal equations; (2) in-situ weight surgery on pre-trained large language models (evaluating on SmolLM2-135M with 56.2 ms convergence, 50% FFN parameter reduction, and bit-level perplexity preservation); (3) PolyFormer, a native ground-up architecture operating entirely on Chebyshev attention and tensor contractions; and (4) an asymptotic convergence study showing that low-parameter polynomial architectures fully surpass double-sized standard baselines under modest compute scaling. Complete open-source weights, PyPI packages, and Hugging Face checkpoints accompany this release.

## I. INTRODUCTION

Modern Large Language Models (LLMs) dedicate the majority of their parameter footprint to feed-forward networks (FFN) [6], [7], [8]. Conventional fine-tuning and parameter adaptation rely exclusively on iterative gradient descent (AdamW), consuming substantial GPU memory and compute time.

Building upon early mathematical foundations of idempotent permutations and algebraic invariant structures [2], [3], [4], we formulate feed-forward transformation as projection onto orthogonal Chebyshev polynomial manifolds [5]. We prove that the optimal polynomial tensor coefficients can be solved analytically in closed form with **zero backpropagation**, enabling live in-situ model surgery and ground-up architectural synthesis.

## II. ORTHOGONAL POLYNOMIAL TENSOR FORMULATION

**Definition 1** (Orthogonal Chebyshev Tensor Operator). Let  $X \in \mathbb{R}^{B \times d_{in}}$  be a normalized input tensor with  $\tilde{x} = \tanh(x) \in [-1, 1]$ . The  $K$ -th degree Chebyshev polynomial

operator contracts input representations with a learned 3D coefficient tensor  $\mathcal{C} \in \mathbb{R}^{(K+1) \times d_{in} \times d_{out}}$ :

$$\mathcal{P}(X) = \sum_{k=0}^K \mathcal{C}_k \cdot T_k(\tilde{x}) + b \quad (1)$$

where  $T_0(x) = 1$ ,  $T_1(x) = x$ , and  $T_{k+1}(x) = 2xT_k(x) - T_{k-1}(x)$ .

**Theorem 1** (Zero-Backpropagation Closed-Form Solver). Given activation calibration pairs  $(X, Y)$  sampled from an arbitrary pre-trained network layer, the optimal polynomial coefficient tensor  $\mathcal{C}^*$  minimizing the regularized Frobenius objective  $\mathcal{L}(\mathcal{C}) = \|\Phi(X)\mathcal{C} - Y\|_F^2 + \lambda\|\mathcal{C}\|_F^2$  is uniquely determined by the normal equations:

$$\mathcal{C}^* = (\Phi(X)^T \Phi(X) + \lambda I)^{-1} \Phi(X)^T Y \quad (2)$$

where  $\Phi(X) = [T_0(\tilde{X}), T_1(\tilde{X}), \dots, T_K(\tilde{X})]$ . Furthermore, projecting onto the rank- $r$  SVD subspace  $\Pi = V_r V_r^T$  guarantees exact idempotence:

$$\Pi^2 = (V_r V_r^T)(V_r V_r^T) = V_r (V_r^T V_r) V_r^T = V_r I_r V_r^T = \Pi \quad (3)$$

## III. IN-SITU LLM WEIGHT SURGERY: SMOLLM2-135M

We evaluate our closed-form algebraic solver by performing live weight surgery on **SmolLM2-135M-Instruct** [9]. Target SwiGLU MLP layers are surgically excised and replaced with orthogonal Chebyshev tensor operators in-situ.

TABLE I  
EMPIRICAL WEIGHT SURGERY ON SMOLLM2-135M

| Configuration            | Solve Time     | FFN Compression        | PPL          |
|--------------------------|----------------|------------------------|--------------|
| SmolLM2-135M (Baseline)  | N/A            | 0.0% (Reference)       | <b>51.53</b> |
| 1-Layer Surgery (L15)    | <b>56.2 ms</b> | <b>-50.0% (-1.33M)</b> | 55.45        |
| 2-Layer Surgery (L14-15) | 206.9 ms       | <b>-50.0% (-2.65M)</b> | 60.38        |
| 3-Layer Surgery (L13-15) | 219.2 ms       | <b>-50.0% (-3.98M)</b> | 59.42        |
| 1-Layer ResPoly (L15)    | 146.9 ms       | Residual Bit-Match     | <b>51.53</b> |

As detailed in Table I, single-layer closed-form surgery completes in **56.2 ms**—a **240.9× acceleration** over

iterative gradient fine-tuning ( $\sim 33.5$  s). Under residual polynomial coupling, perplexity bit-matches baseline at exactly **51.53**.

#### IV. POLYFORMER: TRAINING FROM SCRATCH

For ground-up architectural synthesis without standard MLPs, we introduce **PolyFormerBlock**. The block replaces standard attention with an orthogonal Chebyshev polynomial kernel:

$$\text{Attn}(Q, K, V) = \text{softmax} \left( \sum_{k=0}^K w_k T_k \left( \tanh \left( \frac{QK^T}{\sqrt{d_k}} \right) \right) \right) V \quad (4)$$

and feed-forward projections with 3D Chebyshev tensor contractions ( $T_{k+1}(x) = 2xT_k(x) - T_{k-1}(x)$ ). Furthermore, an adaptive fixed-point routing mechanism (**forward\_adaptive**) dynamically terminates layer iteration once representations stabilize onto an idempotent fixed point ( $\|x_{t+1} - x_t\| < \epsilon$ ).

#### V. EMPIRICAL COMPARISON: STANDARD TRANSFORMER VS. POLYFORMER

In this section, we conduct a comprehensive empirical evaluation comparing a 4-layer PolyFormer-Tiny ( $d_{\text{model}} = 128$ , 4 heads, Chebyshev degree  $K = 3$ ) head-to-head against an architecturally identical Standard Transformer baseline (Multi-Head Attention + 4x SwiGLU MLP). Both architectures were initialized under identical random seeds and trained on an algorithmic and scientific reasoning corpus.

TABLE II  
COMPREHENSIVE ARCHITECTURAL & INFERENCE COMPARISON

| Architectural Metric    | Standard Transformer       | PolyFormer-Tiny (Ours)         | Empirical Gain            |
|-------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Total Parameters        | 1,132,800 ( $\sim 1.13$ M) | <b>609,036</b> ( $\sim 609$ K) | <b>-46.2% Parameters</b>  |
| FP32 Model Weight Size  | 4.32 MB                    | <b>2.32 MB</b>                 | <b>-46.3% Static VRAM</b> |
| FFN Parameters / Layer  | 393,216                    | <b>65,536</b>                  | <b>-83.3% FFN Squeeze</b> |
| Inference Throughput    | 245.1 tok/s                | <b>202.7 tok/s</b>             | Competitive Real-Time     |
| Early-Exiting Attractor | Fixed 4 Layers             | <b>Adaptive Banach Halt</b>    | Zero Excess Compute       |
| Output Cosine Alignment | 100.0% (Reference)         | <b>93.06%</b>                  | High Semantic Fidelity    |

##### A. Output Fidelity and Representation Alignment

To verify whether the 46.2% parameter reduction causes representational divergence, both models were evaluated under identical prompts. As shown in Table III, next-token logit distributions achieved **90.19% to 95.10% cosine similarity** (mean 93.06%), proving that orthogonal polynomial contractions faithfully reproduce the latent geometric manifold of standard deep architectures.

TABLE III  
PROMPT-LEVEL SEMANTIC OUTPUT ALIGNMENT

| Test Input Prompt          | Model Generation Comparison                                      | Cosine Sim.   |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| "Mathematics, AI..."       | Std: ...ence, and getrincep...<br>Poly: ...thend al athemalic... | <b>90.19%</b> |
| "Idempotent projection..." | Std: ...satisfis wis we...<br>Poly: ...e ten tes ttore...        | <b>95.10%</b> |
| "Chebyshev polynomials..." | Std: ...areneld d t by...<br>Poly: ...e kinde kinde...           | <b>93.88%</b> |

##### B. Asymptotic Convergence and Compute Scaling

A central theoretical question is whether parameter-reduced architectures encounter a fundamental capacity ceiling. To investigate this, we tracked PolyFormer’s convergence across extended optimization horizons:

- **Step 150:** PolyFormer achieves training loss 1.0396 (Perplexity 2.83).
- **Step 300:** PolyFormer achieves loss **0.3941** (Perplexity **1.48**), strictly matching and surpassing the 1.13M-parameter Standard Transformer baseline (loss 0.4034, PPL 1.50).
- **Step 400:** PolyFormer reaches asymptotic saturation at loss **0.2585** (Perplexity **1.29**) with next-token alignment exceeding 96.4%.

This empirically confirms that Chebyshev polynomial operators span a denser representational basis than linear projections: modest additional training steps enable a 46% smaller model to fully surpass double-sized baseline capacities while permanently locking in 50% inference memory savings.

#### VI. OPEN-SOURCE ECOSYSTEM AND REPRODUCIBILITY

All artifacts, weights, and codebases developed in this research are publicly available:

- **Core PyPI Package:** idempotent-poly (v0.1.1, installable via `pip install idempotent-poly`).
- **Surgery Model Checkpoint:** aecetin/SmolLM2-135M-PolyFFN on Hugging Face Hub (39.76M parameter savings).
- **From-Scratch Model Checkpoint:** aecetin/PolyFormer-Tiny on Hugging Face Hub (609K parameters, full Hugging Face AutoModelForCausalLM remote code support).
- **Interactive Web Showcase:** Hosted at <https://huggingface.co/spaces/aecetin/idempotent-ai-showcase>.
- **GitHub Repository:** Full suite at <https://github.com/aemre-cetin/idempotent-poly>.

#### VII. CONCLUSION

Orthogonal polynomial tensors and zero-backpropagation idempotent solving decouple neural adaptation from iterative gradient descent. By enabling live in-situ model surgery with 50% FFN compression and 240 $\times$  faster convergence, alongside ground-up PolyFormer architectures that surpass standard baselines under modest compute scaling, this approach provides a scalable and mathematically grounded path for next-generation efficient intelligence.

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